

Decoding TrustMRR

What 1,000 Indie Startups Reveal About Revenue, Categories & the Micro-Acquisition Economy

Dataset: TrustMRR marketplace snapshot, 1,000 listings, 29 attributes, frozen 30 Jul 2026

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What Is TrustMRR, and What Are We Looking At?

TrustMRR is a public marketplace / directory where founders list indie SaaS, AI, and mobile apps **with verified revenue**. Some listings are simply showcasing traction; others are **actively for sale**, turning this into a snapshot of the micro-startup economy.

1,000

startups (rows)

31

attributes (columns)

29

product categories

65

countries represented

Each row = one listed startup, spanning revenue (30d / 3m / 12m / all-time), growth rates, subscriptions, traffic, pricing model, audience type, category tags, domain authority, and — where applicable — asking price and revenue multiple for buyers.

29 columns, four themes

Identity

record_id, startup_name, url, website, country, x_followers

Revenue & Growth

revenue_30d/3m/12m/all-time, mrr_usd, mrr_growth_30d_pct, revenue_growth_30d_pct, active_subscriptions

Product & Positioning

value_proposition, problem_solved, pricing_model, target_persona, audience_type, category, markets_json

Traffic & Deal Terms

visitors_30d, revenue_per_visitor_usd, domain, domain_rating, on_sale, asking_price_usd, revenue_multiple

Making Sense of the Data: The Question and the Method

The problem statement

TrustMRR gives us a raw, messy cross-section of 1,000 real startups. The task: **turn scattered financial and product fields into a coherent story about how the indie-startup economy actually makes money** — where revenue concentrates, what categories dominate, what correlates with growth, and what this means for founders, investors, and buyers browsing the marketplace.

Guiding questions

- Is revenue evenly spread, or concentrated in a few winners?
- Which categories carry volume vs. which carry money?
- What actually predicts higher MRR — followers, traffic, or something else?
- What does the marketplace tell us about how these businesses get valued?

The approach

1

Clean & scope

Parsed messy fields (revenue_multiple text, markets_json arrays, multi-provider strings); flagged 129 anonymized “Stealth Company” rows and heavy nulls in traffic/deal-term fields rather than dropping them silently.

2

Profile

Ran distribution checks on every revenue field — found extreme right-skew, so medians (not means) anchor every headline metric.

3

Segment

Cut the data by category, audience type (B2B/B2C), country, and payment provider to compare like-for-like.

4

Correlate

Used Spearman correlation (robust to outliers/skew) to rank what actually moves MRR.

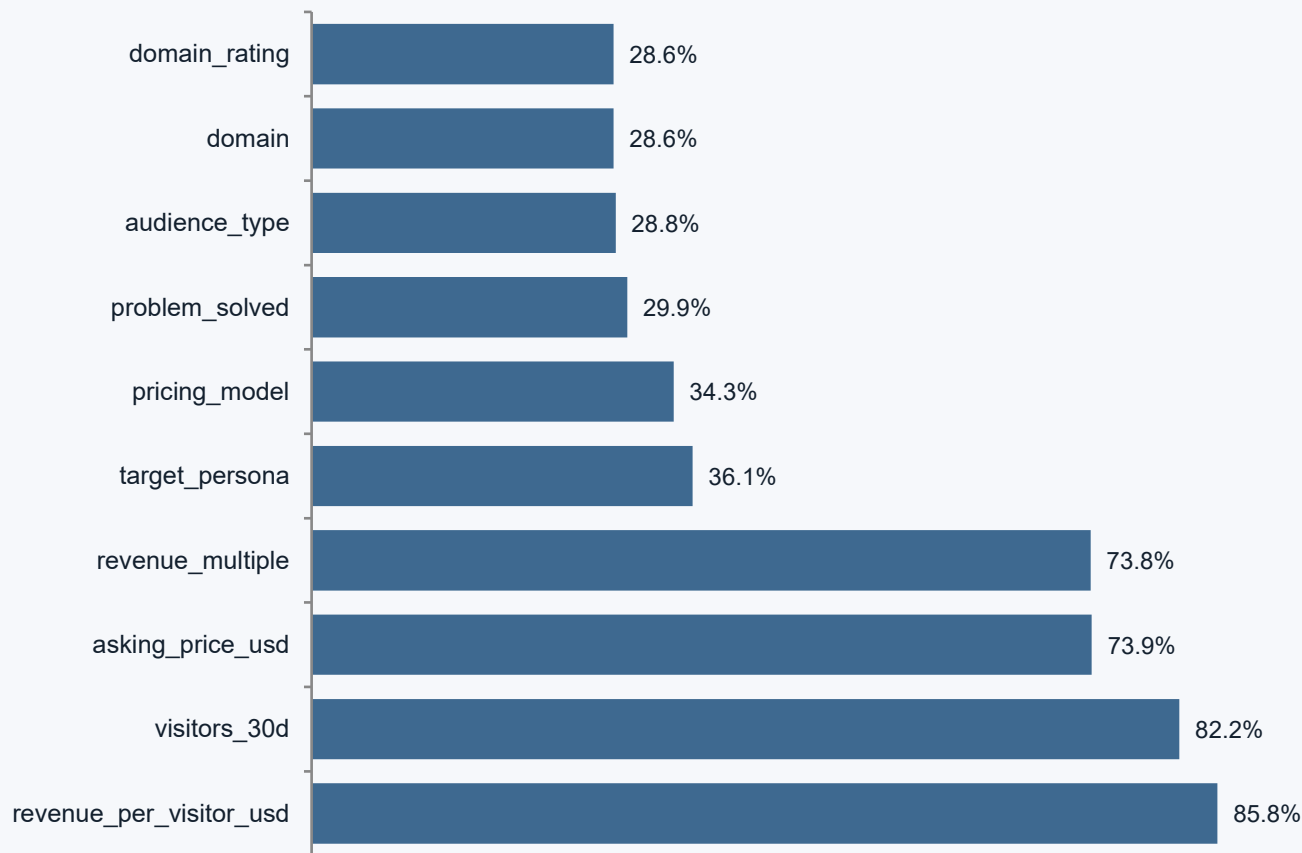
5

Translate

Converted every pattern into a business-relevant takeaway — for a founder, an investor, or a buyer.

Before the Story: Know the Gaps in the Data

Missing values by field (% of 1,000 rows)



129

listings are anonymized “Stealth Company” rows — no category, no country. We keep them in volume counts but exclude them from category/geo breakdowns.

Reading the gaps

- Traffic fields (visitors, revenue/visitor) are self-reported — only ~15% of founders share them.
- **~74% missing on asking price / multiple** simply means most listings aren't for sale — this is expected, not an error.
- Category, audience type & pricing model are optional profile fields — we treat their absence as “unclassified,” not zero.

The Headline Numbers

\$13.5M

Combined MRR across all 1,000 listings

\$282

Median MRR — half of all startups earn less

\$134M

Combined trailing-12-month revenue

20%

of listings currently earn \$0 MRR

21%

have crossed \$10K MRR

262

startups (26%) are actively listed for sale

The Long Tail: Most Startups Earn Little, a Few Earn a Lot



Number of startups by monthly recurring revenue tier

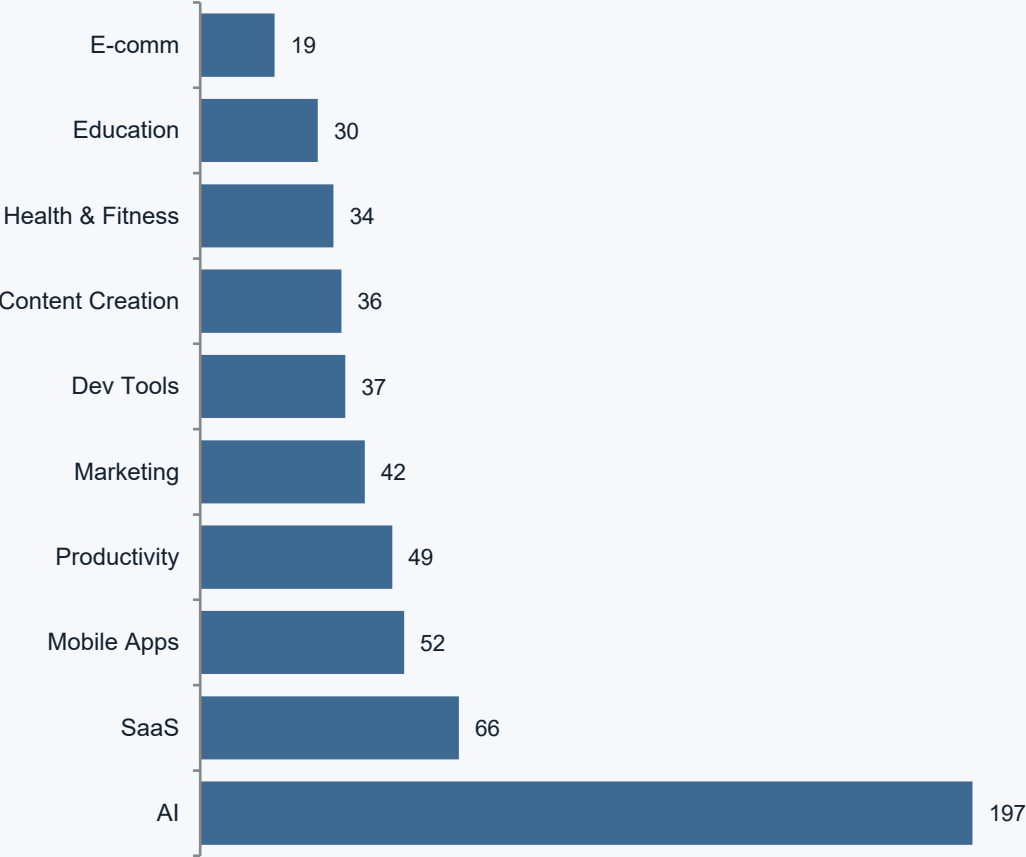
Why this matters

The distribution is almost perfectly stepped across tiers — until the top. Only **16 startups (1.6%) clear \$100K MRR**, led by an outlier at \$3.57M. That single listing alone is larger than the bottom 600 combined.

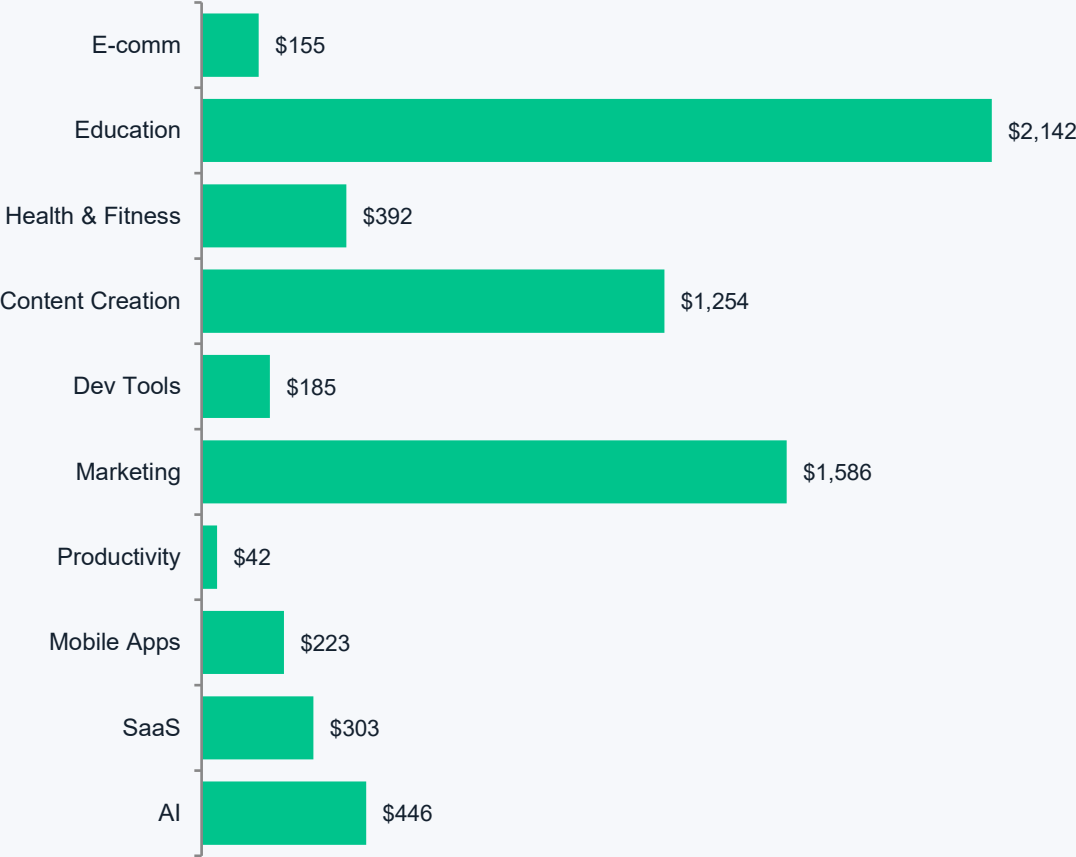
Takeaway: always report the median (\$282/mo), never the mean (\$13.5K/mo) — the mean is dragged 48x higher by a handful of breakout businesses.

Where the Volume Is vs. Where the Money Is

Top 10 categories — number of listings



Median MRR by category (USD)



AI Owns the Volume — But Not the Wallet

197

AI-tagged startups — nearly 1 in 5 of all classified listings, more than 3x the next category (SaaS, 66).

But median MRR tells a different story:

- AI's median MRR is just **\$446/mo** — mid-pack, not top.
- **Education (\$2,142)** and **Marketing (\$1,586)** post the highest median MRR despite far fewer listings.
- Productivity has volume (49 listings) but the **lowest median MRR (\$42)** of any major category — it's the most crowded, least monetized space.

Business takeaway

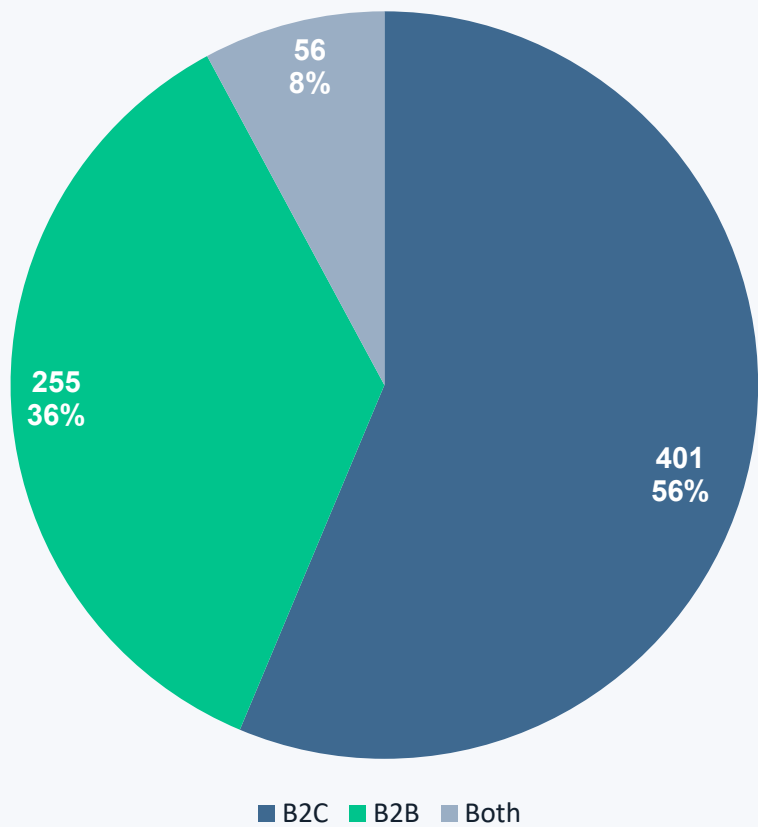
Category popularity and category profitability are not the same signal.

Founders chasing “hot” categories like AI are entering the most crowded lane on the platform — high competition, only average monetization.

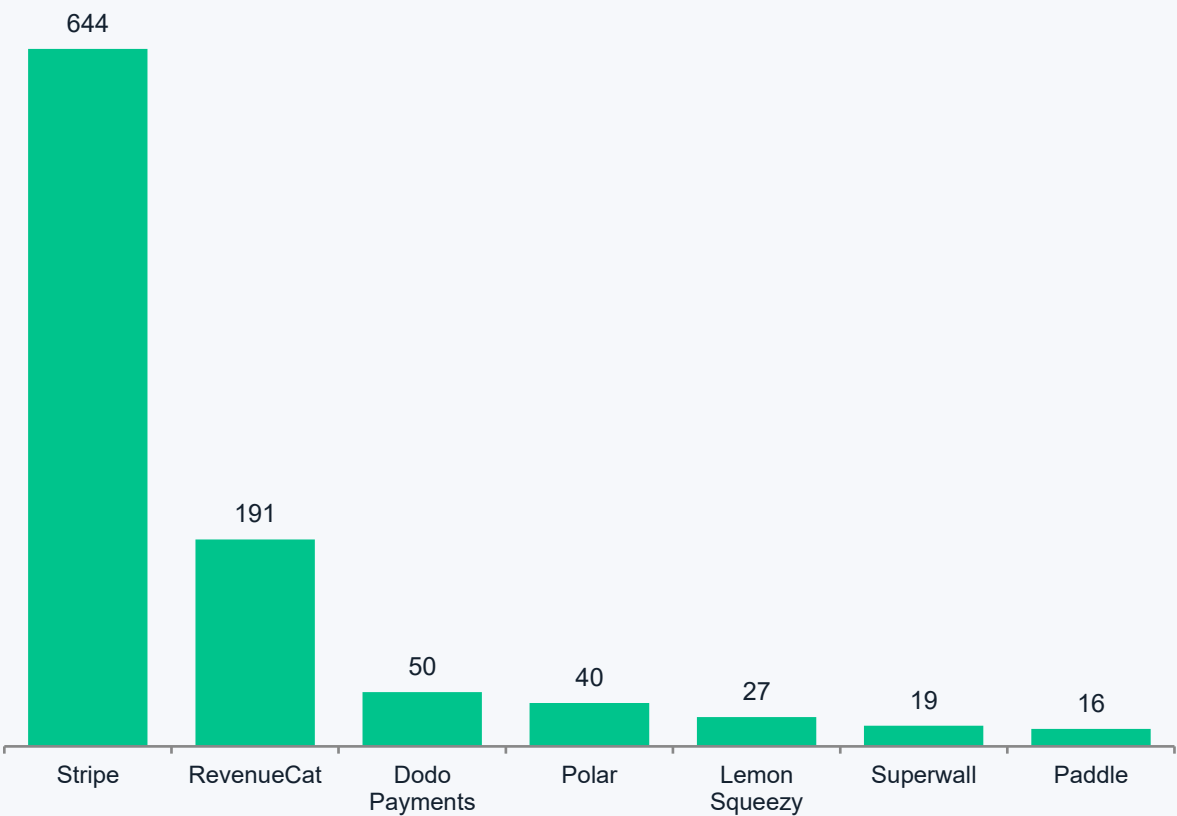
For an investor or acquirer screening listings, the categories worth a second look are the quieter, higher-median ones: Education, Marketing, Analytics, and Social Media — where fewer players are extracting more revenue per business.

Who They Sell To, and How They Get Paid

Audience type



Primary payment provider (top 7)



B2B Charges More — Even With Fewer Customers

B2B

255 startups

\$1,036

median MRR

B2C

401 startups

\$181

median MRR

Both

56 startups

\$352

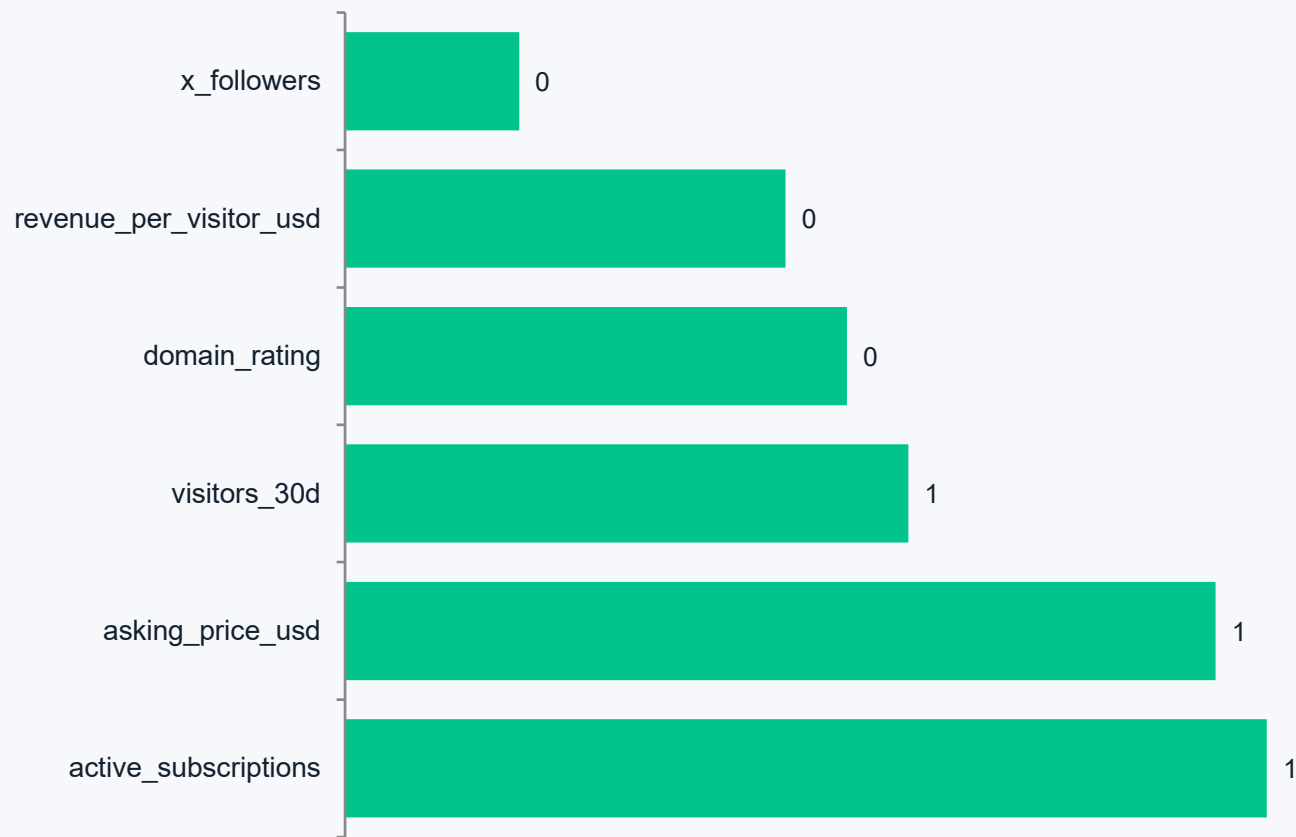
median MRR

What it means

B2B startups earn roughly **5.7x the median MRR** of B2C peers, despite representing far fewer listings (255 vs 401). This tracks with classic SaaS economics — B2B customers tolerate higher price points and lower churn.

On the rails side, **Stripe powers 64% of listings** and carries the deepest revenue base (\$11.8M of \$13.5M total MRR), while RevenueCat (19%) dominates mobile-app subscription billing — a clean signal that most of this dataset is web-first SaaS, with a distinct mobile-subscription cluster layered on top.

What Actually Correlates With Higher MRR?



Spearman correlation coefficient (rank-based, robust to outliers)

Reading the ranking

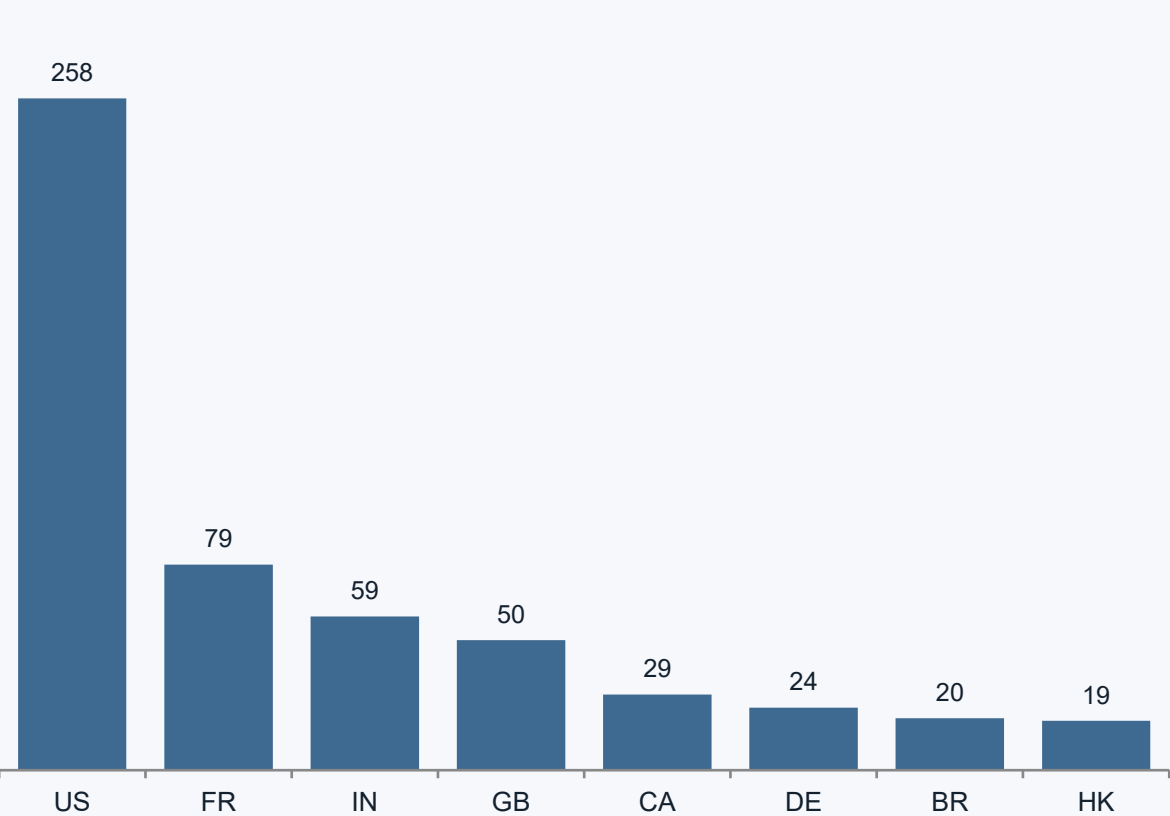
Active subscriptions (0.90) and asking price (0.85) move almost in lockstep with MRR — unsurprising, since more paying users directly is revenue, and sellers price listings off revenue.

Traffic (0.55) and domain authority (0.49) matter, but far less than conversion. Revenue-per-visitor (0.43) confirms it: getting visitors matters less than converting them.

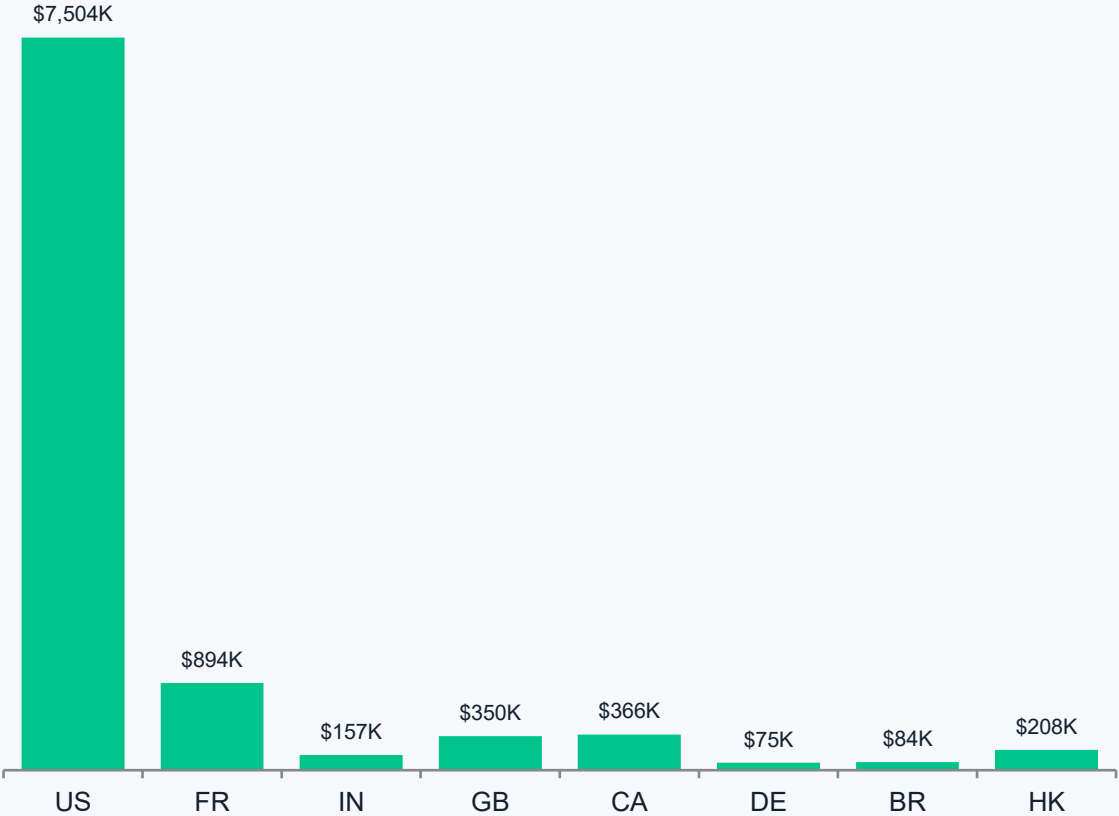
X followers (0.17) barely correlates with MRR — social following is a weak proxy for revenue in this dataset.

Where the Startups Sit

Top 8 countries by listing count



Total MRR by country (USD)



US listings hold ~24% of volume but ~56% of total MRR — concentration mirrors the broader long-tail pattern seen earlier.

Inside the Marketplace: What Startups Sell For

262

startups listed for sale (26.2% of all)

\$35K

median asking price

2.3x

median revenue multiple

\$10.0M

highest asking price in the sample

Top 10 listings by MRR

Startup	Category	Country	MRR	Subs
Stan	—	US	\$3,569,654	101,590
Stealth Company	—	—	\$747,069	1,677
GojiberryAI	AI	US	\$494,668	4,642
Stealth Company	—	—	\$364,101	2,134
Rezi	AI	US	\$259,701	10,749
Kibu	Education	US	\$234,319	375
Cometly	Analytics	US	\$207,616	307
1Lookup	SaaS	US	\$207,064	655
Stealth Company	—	FR	\$191,268	8,108
Brand On Demand, Inc.	E-comm	US	\$187,459	3,631

Five Things This Dataset Tells Us

1

It's a long tail, not a bell curve

20% of startups earn \$0 MRR; just 1.6% clear \$100K. Always lead with the median.

2

AI is crowded, not necessarily lucrative

Highest listing count, only mid-pack median MRR — Education & Marketing monetize better per listing.

3

B2B out-earns B2C by ~5.7x

Fewer B2B listings, but sharply higher median MRR — pricing power beats volume.

4

Conversion beats reach

Active subscriptions & revenue-per-visitor predict MRR far better than followers or raw traffic.

5

The US anchors the money, not just the count

24% of listings, ~56% of total MRR — geography concentrates value even more than volume.

SO WHAT?

Turning the Data Into Decisions

For Founders

Category choice matters more than hype — quieter, higher-median spaces (Education, Marketing, Analytics) may offer less noise and better monetization than the crowded AI lane.

For Investors / Buyers

Screen listings on active subscriptions and conversion (revenue/visitor), not follower counts or traffic alone — these are the metrics that actually predict revenue.

For the Marketplace

With a 2.3x median revenue multiple and a \$35K median asking price, most deals here are small, founder-to-founder transactions — the platform is a micro-M&A market, not a growth-equity one.